PROCEDURE CONSENT · ONE FORM PER EYE

Cataract Surgery & Lens Implant Informed Consent

Please read this carefully and initial each section. Your surgeon will answer any questions before you sign. You may change your mind at any time before surgery.

Completed by: Patient + surgeon | Use as: Consent form (e-signature) | Time: 10 min

Patient full name	Date of birth	Patient ID (office use)	Date completed

01 The procedure

Eye to be operated: ○ Right eye (OD) ○ Left eye (OS)

Surgeon: _____

Planned date: _____

What is a cataract and how is it treated?

Initials: _____

A cataract is clouding of the eye's natural lens, causing blur, glare and faded colours. No eye drop or medicine reverses it. Surgery removes the cloudy lens through a small incision (usually with ultrasound, sometimes assisted by a laser) and replaces it with a permanent artificial lens (intraocular lens, IOL). It is usually done as day surgery under local anaesthetic drops or injection, with or without light sedation.

Expected benefits

Initials: _____

Most patients see more clearly with less glare. Improvement cannot be guaranteed; other conditions such as macular degeneration, diabetic retinopathy, glaucoma or amblyopia can limit the result.

Alternatives

Initials: _____

You may choose not to have surgery or to delay it. Updated glasses, brighter lighting and magnification may help for a time. Cataracts usually worsen gradually; very advanced cataracts can make surgery more complex.

02 Risks

Cataract surgery is one of the most common and successful operations, but every surgery carries risk. Your surgeon will discuss your personal risk factors.

Common and usually temporary

Initials: _____

- Grittiness, dryness, redness, watering, light sensitivity
- Blurred vision for days to weeks
- Inflammation or raised eye pressure needing extra drops
- Floaters; bruising around the eye
- Clouding of the lens capsule behind the implant months or years later (posterior capsule opacification), treated with a quick in-office laser (YAG capsulotomy)

Less common — Initials

- Swelling of the retina (cystoid macular oedema) or cornea
- Tear in the lens capsule, loss of vitreous gel, or lens fragments left in the eye — may need a second operation
- Implant moving out of position
- Need for glasses after surgery, or a lens exchange / laser if the refractive result is not as planned
- Glare, halos, shadows or arcs of light (dysphotopsia)
- Droopy eyelid or double vision

Rare but serious — Initials

- Infection inside the eye (endophthalmitis)
- Retinal detachment
- Bleeding inside the eye
- Persistent corneal swelling requiring a corneal transplant
- Severe permanent loss of vision, or very rarely loss of the eye

Anaesthesia — Initials

Risks include bruising, discomfort, and (with injections) rare damage to the eye or optic nerve. Sedation may cause drowsiness or, rarely, breathing or heart problems; the anaesthesia team will discuss these.

Risks specific to me discussed by my surgeon

03 Lens implant & refractive goal

Lens chosen

- ○ Standard monofocal
- ○ Toric (astigmatism-correcting)
- ○ Extended depth of focus (EDOF)
- ○ Multifocal / trifocal
- ○ Light-adjustable lens
- ○ Monovision plan

Focused for

- ○ Distance
- ○ Intermediate
- ○ Near

Target refraction

Implant model (office)

Glasses after surgery — Initials

I understand that even with the planned lens I may need glasses for some activities, and that the final prescription is usually stable 4–6 weeks after surgery.

Premium lens costs — Initials

If I have chosen a toric, EDOF, multifocal or light-adjustable lens or additional laser services, I understand that part of the cost may not be covered by my insurance (including Medicare) and that I have been given a written estimate of amount.

04 My responsibilities

Before and after surgery — Initials

- Tell the team about all medicines, especially **blood thinners** and **tamsulosin / prostate medicines** (even if stopped).
- Use eye drops exactly as instructed and attend all follow-up visits.
- Arrange an adult to take me home. Do not drive until cleared.
- Call **immediately** for increasing pain, worsening vision, increasing redness, or a curtain / shadow in vision.

Other matters — Initials

I consent to unforeseen procedures the surgeon judges necessary during the operation (e.g. placing a different lens or a capsular ring), to the presence of trainees or observers, and to photographs / video for my record.

05 Consent

I have read this form (or had it read to me), had the opportunity to ask questions, and consent to cataract surgery with lens implantation on the eye named above. A separate consent will be signed for the other eye.

Patient signature | **Patient printed name** | **Date**

× | | |

Parent / guardian / legal representative signature (if applicable) | **Printed name** | **Relationship to patient** | **Date**

× | | | |

Clinician statement. I have explained the nature, purpose, benefits, risks and alternatives of the procedure, answered the patient's questions, and believe the patient understands and consents.

Surgeon / clinician signature | **Name & credentials** | **Date**

× | | |

Interpreter name & ID (if used) | **Language** | **Witness signature** | **Witness name**

| | × | |